

VISA INC. — MERCHANT SERVICES DIVISION

Brand Implementation Mandate

Mandate ID: **VMS-2026-0147**

Revision: 2.1 | Classification: Confidential

Effective Date: 2026-01-15 | **Compliance Deadline: 2026-09-30**

1. Mandate Summary

This document constitutes a binding brand mandate issued by Visa Inc. to all participating Merchant Acquirers and their processing partners under the Visa Core Rules and Visa Product and Service Rules (VCRPS). Mandate **VMS-2026-0147** requires implementors to update transaction processing pathways to comply with enhanced Visa routing rules for card-present and card-not-present transactions across all **card_brand: Visa** product lines, including Visa Classic, Visa Gold, Visa Infinite, and Visa Business. Non-compliance by the stated compliance deadline of **2026-09-30** will result in interchange downgrades, chargeback liability shifts, and potential program suspension per Section 12.4 of the Visa Merchant Agreement.

This mandate supersedes circular VMS-2024-0089 (routing table v4) and must be implemented in coordination with the Merchant Services Certification Program described in Section 6 of this document. All affected endpoints must pass Visa Certification Suite v11.2 prior to production deployment.

2. Scope and Applicability

This mandate applies to JPMC Merchant Services processing the following Visa card product families: **Visa Classic**, **Visa Gold**, **Visa Infinite**, **Visa Business Debit**, and **Visa Corporate**. Debit transactions routed via Interlink and PLUS networks are out of scope; those networks are governed by separate mandates. The primary routing change concerns the Brand Authorization Endpoint (BAE) selector logic, which must correctly identify and forward transactions to the Visa Certified Authorization Platform (VCAP) based on BIN range, product ID, and usage code.

3. Brand Rules and Operational Constraints

3.1 Routing Decision Logic

All transactions bearing Visa BIN ranges 4000000–49999999 MUST be routed through the primary Visa authorization path. The brand routing decision MUST occur within 50ms of transaction receipt and MUST be logged to the audit ledger with a routing reason code. Dual-message transactions must retain the authorization hold and settlement record in the same processing session. Fallback routing to the secondary VCAP endpoint is permitted only upon a verified primary endpoint timeout ($\geq 3000\text{ms}$) and MUST be flagged in the authorization response with Response Code 91 ('Issuer or switch is inoperative').

3.2 Card Verification Requirements

Contactless transactions above USD 100.00 MUST request Cardholder Verification Method (CVM) results as defined in EMV Contactless Kernel C-2 (Visa payWave). The brand rules for CVM processing are: (a) Online PIN preferred for transactions above USD 250.00; (b) Signature acceptable as fallback at attended terminals; (c) No CVM permitted only for transit/toll scenarios whitelisted in the merchant category code (MCC) table. The CVM result byte must be populated in DE 55 (ICC Data) of the authorization request.

3.3 Token Service Provider (TSP) Rules

Transactions originating from Visa Token Service (VTS) must preserve the Token Requestor ID (TRID) and Token Reference ID (TRID) through the full authorization chain. The merchant acquirer MUST NOT substitute the token for a PAN prior to forwarding to VCAP. De-tokenization is the exclusive responsibility of the Visa Token Service Operator as mandated in Visa VTS Implementation Guide v7.3.

4. Certification and Conformance Requirements

All implementations governed by mandate VMS-2026-0147 MUST obtain Visa Merchant Certification (VMC) Level 3 prior to the compliance deadline. The certification process comprises three phases:

Phase 1 — Pre-certification Testing: Acquirer submits test vectors from the Visa Certification Suite (VCS) v11.2 test harness. Minimum pass rate: 98% of mandatory test cases, 80% of optional test cases.

Phase 2 — Integration Validation: End-to-end transaction trace submitted to Visa Certification Authority (VCA) via the Visa Resolve Online (VROL) portal. Must include at least 500 production-representative transactions spanning all product families in scope.

Phase 3 — Production Monitoring: 30-day post-deployment monitoring period with daily metrics submission to Visa Risk Operations. Any authorization decline rate increase exceeding 0.5 percentage points above the 90-day baseline triggers an automatic hold pending Visa review. Certification status must be renewed annually.

Failure to achieve VMC Level 3 by 2026-09-30 results in automatic interchange downgrade to unqualified rate tier (currently 1.95% + USD 0.15 per transaction) and chargeback liability shift to the acquiring bank.

5. Compliance Deadline and Milestones

Milestone	Target Date	Owner
Technical design review complete	2026-03-31	JPMC Merchant Tech
VCS v11.2 test harness integration	2026-05-31	JPMC QA
Phase 1 certification submitted	2026-06-30	JPMC Merchant Tech

Phase 2 integration validation	2026-08-15	JPMC + Visa VCA
Production deployment (UAT → PROD)	2026-09-15	JPMC Ops
COMPLIANCE DEADLINE (VMS-2026-0147)	2026-09-30	All parties

6. Normative References

- Visa Core Rules and Visa Product and Service Rules (VCRPS), April 2026 edition
- Visa Certification Suite (VCS) v11.2 Test Specification
- EMV Contactless Kernel C-2 Specification v2.9 (Visa payWave)
- Visa Token Service (VTS) Implementation Guide v7.3
- Prior Mandate: VMS-2024-0089 (superseded by this document)
- Visa Merchant Agreement, Section 12.4